

Asboth/Solve Any Data Analysis Problem!



about the author

David Asboth is a "data generalist." Currently he works as a freelance data consultant and educator with an MSc. in Data Science and has a background in software and web development in various industries. His previous roles have been a range of data science, software development, and software architecting jobs, and his latest interest is figuring out what skills the analysts of the future actually need to succeed. Beyond having over a decade's worth of technical experience in multiple industries, David co-hosts the Half Stack Data Science podcast about data science in the real world, has spoken at multiple conferences including the Data Science Festival in London, and has taught a variety of data science courses to enterprise students including large banks and consultancies. David has taught hundreds of students introductory data science over the years and wanted to write a book about what he thinks students like those could benefit from after learning the basics.

about the book

Data science education is often focused on beginners; there is no shortage of resources to learn the technical basics to get started with data science. The two biggest questions learners have after completing

Asboth/Solve Any Data Analysis Problem!

such content are: 1) what should I learn next? and 2) how do these skills apply to the real world? This book aims to answer both questions. It provides realistic, true-to-life example projects (no predicting the survivors of the Titanic here!) for learners to attempt to improve their skills and build up a portfolio. Beyond the projects, the book provides a framework for future learning and practice, which will be valuable for data professionals at all levels.

By the end of this book, the reader will understand:

- Some of the less-taught but essential data science skills used and topics encountered in industry
- The process of identifying a high-level solution to a data science problem, researching the required skills and technologies, and adapting solutions to fit a project's constraints
- The importance of building a data science project portfolio to stand out in the job market

And the reader will be able to:

- Solve any future data science problem they come across, even if they don't currently possess the required knowledge
- Create a portfolio of true-to-life data science projects
- More confidently learn any skill/technology they require in the future

minimally qualified reader

- Beginner to intermediate - aspiring/junior data professional
- Exposure to data analysis techniques

table of contents

1. Bridging the gap between data science training and the real world
 - 1.1 The data analyst's toolkit
 - 1.2 A result-driven approach
 - 1.3 Project structure
2. Project 1: Identifying customer geographies
 - 2.1 Project brief: where are your customers based?
 - 2.2 Example solution: finding London
 - 2.3 How to use the rest of the book
3. Project 2: Who are your customers?
 - 3.1 The importance of data modeling
 - 3.2 Project brief: inferring customer base from transaction data
 - 3.3 Step-by-step breakdown: ideas for customer data modeling
 - 3.4 Example solution
 - 3.5 Further reading on data modeling
4. Project 3: Metrics matter
 - 4.1 How your defined metrics affect your outcomes
 - 4.2 Project brief: Finding the "best" performing products
 - 4.3 Step-by-step breakdown: Different metric definitions
 - 4.4 Example solution
 - 4.5 Further reading on metrics
5. Project 4: Getting creative with data sources
 - 5.1 Identifying novel data sources
 - 5.2 Project brief: Impact of the COVID-19 lockdown periods on the film industry
 - 5.3 Step-by-step breakdown: Extracting data from PDFs
 - 5.4 Example solution
 - 5.5 Next steps for exploring data sources
6. Project 5: Handling categorical data

Asboth/Solve Any Data Analysis Problem!

- 6.1 Working with categorical data
- 6.2 Project brief: Developer attitudes towards AI tools
- 6.3 Step-by-step breakdown: Analyzing the developer survey
- 6.4 Example solution: How do developers use AI?
- 6.5 Closing thoughts on categorical data
- 7. Project 6: The importance of time (series)
 - 7.1 Prevalence of time series in industry
 - 7.2 Project brief
 - 7.3 Step-by-step breakdown
 - 7.4 Example solution
 - 7.5 Closing thoughts
- 8. Project 7: Get other people's hands on your work
 - 8.1 Principles of rapid prototyping
 - 8.2 Project brief
 - 8.3 Step-by-step breakdown
 - 8.4 Example solution
 - 8.5 Closing thoughts
- 9. Project 8: Inheriting a project
 - 9.1 How to approach someone else's work
 - 9.2 Project brief
 - 9.3 Step-by-step breakdown
 - 9.4 Example solution
 - 9.5 Closing thoughts
- 10. Closing thoughts
 - 10.1 How do I continue learning?
 - 10.2 What professional skills are important for data science?
 - 10.3 What does the future of learning data science look like?